

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Owner sharpening the loan registration funnel.*

Positioning, nearly ten years owning complex user journeys, cross-functional delivery, and data-driven iteration — brought to smava's onboarding route.

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§ WHY SMAVA

smava's proposition is structurally interesting: the registration route sits at the exact intersection of marketing performance and product quality, where a single funnel drop-off point can cost thousands of qualified leads per week. The job description names direct QA ownership alongside A/B experimentation — that combination signals a team that ships rather than theorises, which is the environment where I work best. The fact that the role coordinates between Marketing and peer product teams means the output is measured in shared KPIs, not internal opinions. *That is exactly the kind of cross-functional accountability where my strengths compound.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

My background does not include a prior role inside a consumer lending or credit-comparison platform specifically. What I do have is strong user-journey ownership across regulated, high-stakes onboarding flows — healthcare, insurance, and identity — where drop-off and compliance friction are equally real constraints. The mechanic transfers directly: break the funnel into testable hypotheses, run disciplined experiments, and make the data visible to the teams upstream and downstream.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, spec drafting, edge-case generation, and requirement refinement
- **GitHub Copilot**, in-repo implementation support and review
- **Cursor / VSCode**, LLM-assisted development environment
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping for user-journey mockups
- **Framer**, design-heavy interactive prototypes
- **GPT**, research synthesis and stakeholder communication drafts
- **Gamma.app**, structured product presentations and workshop decks
- **n8n**, lightweight workflow automation and experiment scaffolding

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, Django, JavaScript, PostgreSQL, dbt, Dagster, DuckDB, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Argo Workflows, Helm, Jenkins, Bitbucket, Git, REST APIs, Kotlin (Spring Boot), MongoDB, Redpanda, OpenShift, MicroStrategy, AngularJS, Ionic, CGM API integrations, Shopware, Java, HTML/CSS, Low-code platforms.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT SMAVA

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow every step of the registration route as an actual user, sit in on existing A/B test reviews, read the backlog and analytics dashboards, and map where data confidence is high versus where the team is guessing.

WEEK 2

Slice and prioritise.

Work with Engineering and Data to identify the one funnel segment with the highest drop-off and the clearest testable hypothesis, and draft the experiment brief so it can enter the sprint immediately.

Ship and close loops.

Run QA on the first experiment deployment, ensure Marketing has a shared view of results, and establish a lightweight reporting cadence that makes team impact legible to the broader organisation.

I COVER LETTER

Dear smava team,

The registration route is not a feature – it is the handshake between every euro of marketing spend and every loan offer that reaches a customer. I have spent the better part of a decade owning exactly that kind of high-stakes, data-instrumented user journey, and the smava Product Owner role maps cleanly onto how I work.

At Rohde & Schwarz, I owned end-to-end delivery on a data platform where the "onboarding" was a multimodal data ingestion pipeline feeding downstream ML training. The analogy to a credit-comparison funnel is direct: a user enters with a need, the system qualifies them through a sequence of steps, and every friction point either converts or loses them permanently. I ran that product from user stories through implementation support, QA, and GitOps rollout – the same ownership arc the smava posting describes. At Emil Group, I re-established sprint discipline for a 17-person team that had lost delivery rhythm under pressure, split it into smaller Scrum units with clear ownership, and rebuilt client trust through structured weekly product workshops. That is the kind of cross-functional coordination and delivery accountability I bring to a role.

What excites me specifically about the smava setup is the explicit pairing of A/B testing ownership with direct QA responsibility. Too often experimentation and quality live in separate teams and the handoff between them is where learning gets lost. Owning both means I can design an experiment, instrument it correctly, verify the implementation myself, and close the learning loop with Marketing and peer product teams on factual data rather than approximations. I have operated at that level of end-to-end ownership throughout my career, including serving as Deputy IT Security Officer at the Federal Employment Agency, where I was responsible for data lineage and compliance governance alongside product delivery.

I do not have a prior role inside a consumer lending product specifically. What I have is a demonstrated ability to pick up regulated, high-consequence user journeys quickly and to instrument them for improvement. The onboarding and registration flows I have owned – in healthcare, insurance, and identity – share the same structural challenge as smava's: users arrive with a goal, the system has a compliance requirement, and the product team's job is to reduce the distance between those two realities without losing either.

I would welcome the opportunity to walk through a specific experiment brief or funnel audit as part of the interview process – that is a faster signal of fit than any amount of general conversation.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Manager and Product Owner with nearly ten years of experience owning complex user journeys, cross-functional delivery, and data-instrumented product improvement. Background spans regulated environments, analytics platforms, InsurTech SaaS, and AI data systems. Comfortable operating where requirements are incomplete and priorities shift – equally at home writing acceptance criteria, running QA, and presenting experiment results to Marketing. Strong delivery instincts, low ego, high agency.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- End-to-end funnel ownership from discovery through QA and rollout
- A/B test design, instrumentation, and result communication
- Cross-functional coordination between Engineering, Design, Data, and Marketing
- Backlog management, sprint discipline, and delivery rhythm restoration
- Data-driven prioritisation and KPI-oriented product thinking
- Direct QA ownership alongside concurrent feature delivery
- Structured stakeholder communication in dynamic, fast-moving environments
- Technical fluency enabling independent problem-solving without engineering escalation
- Founder-level pragmatism: ships, does not theorise

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, QA testing, and GitOps-based rollout
- Led cross-functional team including architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD
- Unblocked an infrastructure-level issue independently that engineers had left open for over a year – resolved in one week
- Responsible for data provenance, audit trails, and transparency with multinational stakeholders

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Delivered new features including labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison, and modernised admin tooling across the Arbeitsmarktmonitor platform
- Designed interactive dashboards and community features; standardised CI/CD with full test integration
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer with focus on compliance, governance, and data lineage
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation; migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes

EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Re-established sprint discipline and delivery stability for a team that had lost both; split a bloated 17-person team into smaller, effective Scrum units with clear ownership and deputy roles
- Reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement practices
- Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout
- Regained client trust in a prototype-stage environment through structured communication and weekly product workshops
- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered core flows for digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, and patient document storage across iOS and Android
 - Led a small team under tight deadlines with strict focus on highest-leverage features
 - Built stakeholder trust through transparent communication of technical complexity involving legacy APIs and external databases
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§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Product Owner, Quantum-Secure Encryption

- Owned product architecture for backup, restore/checkpoint, and data encryption; USP was setup under two minutes with no technical knowledge required
- Served as deputy IT security officer; delivered English-language product communication to international audiences

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder & CFO

- Built a group-based P2P payment product end-to-end: PSP integration, full UX/UI design, mobile app prototype
- Product later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

AOK HEALTH INSURANCE / ITSCARE 2019, 2020

Proxy Product Owner

- Migrated internal webshop to Shopware including complex catalogue and API integration and configurable approval policies
 - Coordinated with procurement, compliance, and IT stakeholders throughout delivery
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§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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